

Barrier Breakers 2027 · Judging

How we score, and the sheet you'll use



Every team gets three judges, 60 seconds to pitch, and two minutes of questions. You score three things, 1 to 5 each. That's the whole job. Score before you walk to the next table.

The three questions

1. Do they get the problem?

Who this costs, how much, and why it's stuck that way.

5 They can tell you who pays, roughly what, and why nobody has fixed it. They talked to someone it affects, or found the numbers themselves.

2 A statistic read off the poster. They can't say who, specifically, this is for.

2. Would this actually work?

Not "is it clever." Could it run, and does it reach the people from question 1?

5 There's something on the table: a prototype, a draft, a demo. You can see how it would run and who would run it. It fits the problem they described.

2 An idea with no next step. Or a solution that would help, but not the people they said it was for.

3. Could they explain it?

Clear in 60 seconds. Honest under questions.

5 You understood it before the timer went. They answered what you asked, not what they rehearsed, and every team member could speak to it.

2 You're still not sure what it does. Questions got a shrug, or one person did all the talking and the others looked at the floor.

A few things we care about

- The team that built something ugly that works beats the team with the slick deck.
- Ask the quiet team member a question. Everyone on the team should own the project.
- Use the whole scale. If everyone in your section gets 4s, nobody gets picked.
- Score each team before you move on. Don't go back and adjust once you've seen more.
- Your job is your section's tables. Don't compare to what you hear from other judges.

How it adds up

15

Your top score for one team: three questions, 5 each.

45

A team's panel total: your score plus the two other judges in your section.

1 + 1

Highest panel total in the section goes to Demo Day. Second is the honorable mention. Tie: the three of you talk for a minute and pick.

Demo Day, after lunch. Five finalists, one from each section, pitch for five minutes with two minutes of questions. Every judge who stays scores all five on the same three questions, including the team from their own section. Highest combined total takes 1st.

Scorecard

Barrier Breakers 2027 · Gallery round · 1 to 5 on each question · the first row is a worked example

[illegible]

When you're done: hand this to a FinMango volunteer, or read your totals into your phone. Your section's two highest panel totals are the finalist and the honorable mention.

Problem: do they get it? · Works: could it run, for those people? · Explain: clear in 60 seconds, honest under questions.

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